INCH-POUND

MIL-E-44200B
20 September 1993
SUPERSEDING
MIL-E-44200A
26 October 1988

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ESCALLOPED POTATOES WITH HAM, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This specification is approved for use by all Department and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers thermostabilized escalloped potatoes with ham in flexible pouches for use as a component of the Meal, Ready-to-Eat (MRE), Individual.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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SPECIFICATION

MILITARY

MIL-P-44073 - Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Parts 301-391)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS), U.S. FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

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2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, One Maritime Plaza, 23rd Floor, San Francisco, CA 94111.)

AOAC INTERNATIONAL

Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC

(Application for copies should be addressed to the AOAC International, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.2 Ham, canned, or cooked. The canned or cooked ham shall not be labeled "water added" and shall not contain dextrose. The ham may or may not contain smoke flavoring. The canned or cooked ham shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 60 days from date of pack until preparation of the finished product.

3.2.3 Potatoes, fresh. The potatoes shall be fresh, clean, sound, and of a white flesh variety suitable for canning. The maximum specific gravity for the potatoes shall be 1.075 with a reducing sugar content of not more than 2.0 percent on a dry weight basis.

3.2.4 Potatoes, diced, dehydrofrozen. The diced, dehydrofrozen potatoes shall have been prepared from fresh potatoes meeting the requirements of 3.2.3 and shall be diced as specified in 3.3.2.1.

3.2.5 Shortening, vegetable, powdered. Powdered vegetable shortening shall consist of components which, when combined, will serve as a product whitening agent. The powdered shortening, when used as an ingredient in this product, shall withstand the specified thermoprocessing conditions without browning. A typical analysis of the powdered shortening follows:

Fat	73.50 to 76.50 percent
Protein	0.00 to 06.00 percent
Carbohydrates	14.00 to 24.00 percent
Moisture	2.00 percent maximum

3.2.6 Starch, food, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified waxy maize food starch for use in thermostabilized foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140°F to 170°F and be fully hydrated at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress, and under conditions of cold storage. The cooked slurry prepared from the starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste.

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3.2.7 Margarine. Margarine shall conform to the definition and standard of identity for margarine (21 CFR Part 166) and shall possess a fine and pleasing flavor. The body shall be smooth, firm, and homogenous. The margarine shall possess a uniform medium yellow color and may be salted or unsalted.

3.2.8 Lecithin. Lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.9 Onion powder. Onion powder shall be Fancy grade of the Official Standard and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for dehydrated onion and garlic products.

3.2.10 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner covering have been removed. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot biting, pungent flavor, and a light color. The ground white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.11 Celery seed, ground. Ground celery seed shall be derived from the seed of Apium graveolens L. and shall be light to rich brown in color and shall possess a characteristic celery odor and flavor with a warm, slightly bitter aftertaste. The ground celery seed shall contain not less than 2.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 35 sieve.

3.2.12 Starch, waxy maize, modified, filling and processing aid. The starch shall be a white to off-white, odorless, finely pulverized powder suitable for use as a filling and processing aid in thermostabilized foods. When hydrated at temperatures of 165°F to 200°F, the starch shall develop a paste. The initial viscosity of the paste shall be retained under conditions of moderate shear and prolonged holding times. During retorting at temperatures in excess of 200°F, the starch shall undergo extensive to complete breakdown of the initial viscosity. The starch shall be bland and shall demonstrate easy dispersibility.

3.2.13 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this specification. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

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3.3.1 Preparation of ham. The ham shall be diced into 3/8 inch by 3/8 inch by 1/2 inch to 3/4 inch dices (± 1/16 inch in each dimension). The dices shall be blanched for a sufficient amount of time to comply with all the finished product requirements. The broth shall be retained for use in the sauce preparation (see 3.3.4). If the blanched ham dices and ham broth are not immediately utilized in the product (see 3.3.4 and 3.3.5), the dices and broth shall be maintained separately at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F for not more than 24 hours from the time of dicing to product preparation.

3.3.2 Preparation of potatoes.

3.3.2.1 Preparation of fresh potatoes. The fresh potatoes shall be thoroughly cleaned to remove dark and extraneous material, peeled, trimmed, and thoroughly washed. The washed potatoes shall be mechanically diced into 3/8 inch cubes (± 1/16 inch in each dimension) or 1/2 inch cubes (± 1/16 inch in each dimension). The potato dices shall be blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air. The blanched potatoes shall be immediately cooled with cooling water to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled, drained potatoes dices shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration prior to preparation and filled into the pouches within four hours after blanching.

3.3.2.2 Preparation of dehydrofrozen potatoes. Dehydrofrozen potatoes shall be used without further preparation and handled in a manner to prevent discoloration prior to product preparation.

3.3.3 Filling and processing aid, starch preparation. When a filling and processing aid starch is used, a solution (slurry) shall be prepared with the filling and processing aid starch and part of the sauce formulation water in a concentration adequate to hold ingredients in suspension for uniform distribution during mixing and pumping of product.

3.3.4 Sauce preparation. The sauce shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

Ingredient 1/	Percent by weight
Water and ham broth	89.43
Shortening, vegetable, powdered	4.00
Starch, food, modified, high opacity	3.50
Margarine	2.00
Lecithin	0.25
Onion powder	0.75
Pepper, white, ground	0.06
Celery seed, ground	0.01

1/ The total amount of salt in the formula shall be adjusted, as necessary, to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.6).

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NOTE: The following sauce preparation procedures were used in the development of this product. Alternative procedures may be used provided finished product requirements are met. When alternate procedures are used, the time and temperature requirements specified for the prepared sauce are still applicable.

a. A thin slurry shall be made with the starch, the powdered vegetable shortening, and part of the water.

b. The balance of the water and remaining ingredients shall be mixed together and heated to 180°F to 190°F.

c. The starch slurry shall be added and the sauce vigorously stirred until the temperature reaches 150°F to 170°F.

d. The volume of the sauce shall be adjusted with water to compensate for evaporation during heating and holding.

e. The sauce shall be filled within four hours after cooking. A filling and processing aid starch solution may be added in the amount required to facilitate uniform ingredient distribution in single-stage filling operations when dehyrofrozen potatoes are used. If a hot fill method is used, the prepared sauce shall be held in the temperature range of 150°F to 180°F at all times prior to filling into the pouches. If a cold fill method is used, the prepared sauce shall be cooled immediately and held within a temperature range of 28°F to 40°F at all times prior to filling into the pouches.

3.3.5 Product preparation. The product shall be formulated and prepared to comply with the finished product requirements (see 3.6 and 6.3).

3.4 Pouch filling and sealing. Each pouch (see 5.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Each pouch shall be filled and sealed in accordance with the pouch filling and sealing requirements specified for class 1 of MIL-P-44073.

b. A hot fill system is permitted if compatible with the single-stage or multistage filling and sealing method used.

c. The temperature of the ham, potatoes, and sauce at time of filling shall be as specified (see 3.3.1, 3.3.2, and 3.3.4) for the applicable filling process used.

d. The ingredients may be filled into the pouch using either a single-stage or multistage filling operation.

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e. Each filled and sealed pouch shall be in the retort process within two hours after sealing.

3.5 Pouch thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed pouches shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved. The thermoprocessing operation shall be in compliance with the thermoprocessing requirements for class 1 of MIL-P-44073.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The average net weight shall be not less than 8.0 ounces.

e. No individual pouch shall have a net weight of less than 7.5 ounces.

f. The drained weight of the ham dices in any individual pouch shall be not less than 2.0 ounces.

g. The average drained weight of the ham shall be not less than 2.5 ounces.

h. Not less than 1.5 ounces of the drained weight of the ham shall be intact dices.

i. The drained weight of the potatoes in any individual pouch shall be not less than 1.5 ounces.

j. The average drained weight of the potatoes shall be not less than 2.0 ounces.

k. Not less than 1.1 ounces of the drained weight of the potatoes shall be intact dices.

l. Ham dice texture shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

m. Potato dice texture shall not be hard, rubbery, fibrous, or mushy.

n. Sauce consistency shall be smooth, without lumps, and shall not be excessively thick or thin.

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o. The average fat content of the finished product shall be not greater than 6.0 percent and no individual pouch shall have a fat content greater than 8.0 percent.

p. The salt content of the finished product in any individual pouch shall be not less than 0.5 percent nor greater than 1.2 percent.

q. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The ham component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

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4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material examination. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be examined in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Filled and sealed pouch examination. Examination of the filled and sealed pouches shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

4.5.4 Net weight examination. The net weight of the filled and sealed pouches shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty pouch. Any individual net weight of less than 7.5 ounces shall be scored as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 8.0 ounces.

4.5.5 Product and drained weight examination.

4.5.5.1 Product examination. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65°F to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180°F to 190°F water for 10 minutes, opened, and inspected.

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The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan specified in table I. The contents shall be examined for the defects indicated in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product examination 1/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	--	0	2
	20	40	1	2

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be examined. Defects found in the first and second sample shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Texture of the ham dice is dry, rubbery, or mushy
102	Texture of the potato dice is hard, rubbery, fibrous, or mushy
103	Sauce consistency is lumpy, not smooth, and is excessively thick or thin
104	Product shows evidence of excess heating (materially darkened or scorched)

1/ The presence of any foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

4.5.5.2 Drained weight examination. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65°F to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180°F to 190°F water for approximately 10 minutes, opened and examined. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table III. The drained weights shall be determined and examined for the defects listed in table IV.

TABLE III. Double sampling plan for drained weight examination 1/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	--	0	2
	20	40	1	2

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be examined. Defects found in the first and second sample shall be combined, and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE IV. Drained weight defect 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Drained weight of ham dices in a pouch is less than 2.0 ounces. 2/
102	Drained weight of potatoes in a pouch is less than 1.5 ounces. 3/

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TABLE IV. Drained weight defect (cont'd) 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
103	Of the 2.0 ounces drained weight of ham dices, less than 1.5 ounces are intact ham dices.
104	Of the 1.5 ounces drained weight of potato dices, less than 1.1 ounces are intact potato dices.

1/ To determine drained weight, the pouch contents shall be poured into a flat-bottom container. A minimum of three times the pouch volume of 180°F to 190°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be gently agitated so as to liquify rendered fat and to remove the sauce without breaking the ham dices or potatoes. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/4 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the ham dices or potato dices. The sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45° angle and allowed to drain for two minutes. The drained weight of the ham dices and potato dices shall be determined individually and shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

2/ If the sample average drained weight of the ham dices is less than 2.5 ounces the lot shall be rejected.

3/ If the sample average drained weight of the potato dices is less than 2.0 ounces the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.6 Fat and salt content testing. Eight filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot. The product shall be tested for fat content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, method 976.21, 985.15, or 960.39, and for salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, method 935.47, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The unopened pouches shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the pouches. The pouches shall be opened and the entire contents of each pouch shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat or salt requirements in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Packaging examination. Examination of packaging shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with the requirements of MIL-P-44073.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Product preparation. Production tests have indicated that the following proportion of ingredients should produce a product which complies with the finished product requirements. Minor adjustments of the ingredient percentages by weight may be necessary in order to satisfy the different production systems.

a. When using fresh potatoes:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Ham, diced, blanched	50.0
Potatoes, fresh, diced	25.0
Sauce	25.0

b. When using dehydrofrozen potatoes:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Ham, diced, blanched	50.0
Potatoes, dehydrofrozen	12.5
Sauce	25.0
Water	12.5

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6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Combat field feeding
Operational ration
Pouch food
Shelf stable

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-0745)

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-E-44200B	1993 September 20

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
ESCALLOPED POTATOES WITH HAM, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON/DSN
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	508-651-4501	256-4501
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: SATNC-WT Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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